Exporting Map

Framework
- Intro
- Conclusion
- Body
  - Significance
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
      - Defense — Exercise
    - Tech
      - defense — Exercise
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International
      - Defense
- way forward

Common
- Intro — India and the country X share a strategic relationship, rooted in historical, cultural, and geographical ties
- Body
  - ties
    - Vaccine diplomacy
    - exporting generic medicine
    - yoga for soft power diplomacy
    - provider of IT services
    - Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) scholarships — to prvide education scholarship, etc.
    - ITEC — capcaity building and skill development in other countries
  - Way forwards
    - Balance Diplomacy
      - Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
      - Leverage Political Neutrality — absense of dispute allows scope for positive engagement
    - Collaboration against terrorism — intelligence sharing; joint action mission
    - Military cooperation — joint defense exercise; patrols; Intelligence and survillence cooperation; Subtopic 4
    - sustain aid levels amid china gaoing presence and maintain regional influence
    - Support Bhutan in managing border disputes and strengthen joint defence preparedness.
    - Strengthen cultural and educational ties to foster goodwill,
    - Calibrated engagement
    - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
    - strengthen border security to counter spillover effects
    - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
    - Accelerate Connectivity Projects: Fast-tracking initiatives
- HADR — vaccine diplomacy

China
- Intro — "China is not our enemy, but neither is it our friend." – Former NSA Shivshankar Menon; reflects India's calibrated China policy.
- Conclusion — while navigating competetion with stability india can uphold its interest while contributing to regional balance and multipolarity
- Issues
  - Trade
    - Total — 117Bn
    - Deficit — $85 Bn
    - Import — 101
    - Export — 16
    - Critical imports
      - Solar Modules — 90% of total
      - API (Active Pharma Ingredients) — 80% need
    - Govt Steps
      - PLI — semiconductors — Apple shifting 25% production by 2025 — 9.5L jobs + 12.5L cr production
      - PL Notification 2020 — FDI allowed only though govt route
      - China+1 — diversification of supply chains
  - Border Clashes
    - Issues — Galwan 2020; Border Infra — Medog Dam; Chinese villagesand settlements along borders
    - Friction points — Gogra Hot springs; despang demchok; galwan — 2020; tawang
    - Steps
      - Forward Deployments — 50K+ troops at LAC (Ladakh + Arunanchal)
      - BRO budget increments — Sela Tunnnel cutting tawang time by 1.5 hr
      - India China Border Road Programme — 4000+ Km roads
      - Vibrant Village Programme — Optical fibres, towers, roads
      - Regular talks — Corps Commander level talk; WMCC (working mechanism for consultation and coordination)
      - Amarnath Yatra Rejuvenation in 2025
  - Strategic Rivalry — CPEC through PoK , Hambantotta Port lease
  - Third world theatres — Africa — Solar Parks; Railways
  - Oceans — different understanding of indo pacific region
  - Way Forward
    - China +1 — de-risk supply chains
    - aatmanirbharta in solar modules
    - Border level — disengagements talks; UAV surveillence agreements
    - Maritime — Andeman Theatre Command augmentation as Indo-Pacific outpost
    - Ministerilism — Quad, SCO, BRICS
    - Research — joint glacier + biodiversity research

Pakistan
- Issue
  - Asymmetric Warfare — cross border terrorism; terror base camps; militancy in J&K
  - proxy warfare
  - drug , arms trafficking
  - Chinese factor — CPEC violating indias sovergnity; strategic encirclement via CPEC
  - Border issues
    - Kashmir conflict
    - Siachin — LoC couldn't be demarcated beyond NJ9842 due to bad weather
    - Sir Creek Issue — 92Km marshy land seprating gujrat from sindh
    - Gilgit Baltistan made new 5th province of Pak inside PoK
  - Trade — India withdrawing Most favoured Nation states to Pak
- Intro — India–Pakistan relations remain adversarial, shaped by Partition, Kashmir, cross-border terrorism, and nuclear deterrence—making bilateral engagement fragile yet unavoidable in South Asian geopolitics
- Conclusion — A calibrated blend of deterrence and dialogue, anchored in bilateralism and regional peace, remains the only sustainable pathway forward.
- Way Forward
  - value addition — PM Modi
    - Terror and Talks cannot go together
    - Terror and Trade cannot go together
    - Blood and water cannot flow together
    - Zero tolerance to terror
    - If terror is state policy it will be met with a visible and foreceful response marking the shift from deterrence to direct action
  - Strategic Recalibreation — engaing with pakistan donors to proactively managing
  - sustained dialogue — regular meetings, high level talks, to address issue of trade, terrorism and kashmir
  - COnfidence building measure — communication hotlines, regular meetings to avoid miscalculations
- Shimla Agreement
  - ✶ Basics
    - Signed: 2 July 1972 at Shimla, Himachal Pradesh.
    - Signatories: PM Indira Gandhi (India) & President Zulfikar Ali Bhutto (Pakistan).
    - Context: After 1971 Indo–Pak war, which led to creation of Bangladesh.
  - 1 Key Provisions — Summary
    - Peaceful Bilateralism → Both nations resolved disputes bilaterally, without third-party mediation (rejected UN/USSR/US interference).
    - Respect for Sovereignty → Commitment to UN Charter principles of non-interference, territorial integrity.
    - Line of Control (LoC) → Ceasefire line in J&K renamed LoC, both sides pledged to respect it.
    - Withdrawal of Troops → To pre-war positions (except in J&K, where LoC applied).
    - People-to-People Links → Agreement to promote trade, communication, travel.
    - Prisoners of War (POWs) → Framework set for repatriation (later handled under 1974 Delhi Agreement).
  - 2 Significance
    - De-escalation → prevented further hostilities after decisive Indian military victory.
    - Bilateral Framework → India uses this to reject third-party mediation on Kashmir (e.g., US/UN).
    - Strategic Leverage → India released 90,000 POWs, but without extracting concrete Kashmir settlement → seen as a "missed opportunity."
    - Foundation for Future Engagements → paved way for 1974 Simla spirit → Lahore Declaration (1999), Agra Summit (2001).
  - 3 Criticisms & Challenges
    - Vagueness → did not settle Kashmir issue permanently, left LoC as temporary.
    - Pakistan's Violations → Cross-border terrorism (1980s onwards) → breach of spirit of Shimla.
    - Missed Leverage → India released POWs & captured territory (~5,000 sq. km) without securing permanent recognition of LoC.
    - Internationalisation Attempts → Despite pledge, Pakistan repeatedly sought UN/US involvement in Kashmir.
    - Kargil War (1999) → Major violation of Shimla's commitment to respect LoC.
  - 🚀 Way Forward
    - Reinforce Bilateralism → maintain Shimla principle, reject external mediation.
    - Confidence-Building Measures (CBMs) → people-to-people, trade, cultural exchanges.
    - Counter-Terrorism First → peace talks contingent on ending cross-border terror.
    - Water & Climate Dialogue → extend spirit of Shimla to regional challenges (Indus Waters Treaty reforms).
    - Institutional Mechanism → revive backchannel talks under Shimla framework.
- Operation Sindoor
  - On May 7, 2025 India lauched a precision air strike on pakistani terror camps inside PoK and Pakistan in retaliation of the killings to 26 civilian in Pahalgam massacre terror attack.
  - Drew New Red lines — If terror is state policy it will be met with a visible and foreceful response marking the shift from deterrence to direct action
  - India's air defense — layered air defense — Brahmos; Akash teer; anti aircraft guns for low flying drone; electronic jamming system to supress enemy communication
- IWT
  - ✶ Basics — Signed: 1960, brokered by World Bank between India & Pakistan it Governs sharing of the Indus river system (6 rivers) hailed as one of the "most durable water treaty" in world
  - Indus River System:
    - Western Rivers (80%): Indus, Jhelum, Chenab → allocated to Pakistan.
    - Eastern Rivers (20%): Ravi, Beas, Sutlej → allocated to India.
  - 1 Key Provisions
    - Eastern Rivers (Ravi, Beas, Sutlej) → India has exclusive rights.
    - Western Rivers (Indus, Jhelum, Chenab) → Pakistan has control, but India allowed:
      - Non-consumptive uses: navigation, irrigation (limited), hydroelectric power (run-of-the-river).
      - Restrictions: India cannot store water beyond specific limits.
    - Dispute Settlement:
      - Technical issues — Permanent Indus Commission (PIC): — 2 commissioners (one from each country).; Meets biannually to resolve disputes.
      - Differences → referred to Neutral Expert.
      - Disputes → referred to International Court of Arbitration (ICA).
    - Termination — Mutual agreement to terminate under article XII
  - 2 Achievements
    - Survived wars & conflicts (1965, 1971, Kargil 1999).
    - Enabled India's Bhakra–Nangal, Beas, Indira Gandhi canals → Green Revolution backbone.
    - Allowed Pakistan's irrigation system (largest contiguous canal system).
  - 3 Issues & Challenges
    - Hydropower Disputes → India's Kishanganga (J&K) & Baglihar dams contested by Pakistan.
    - Climate Change → glacial melt, variability in Indus flows threatens treaty balance.
    - Population Pressure → rising demand in both nations.
    - Terrorism Linkages → post-Uri (2016), India hinted at revisiting treaty ("Blood & Water cannot flow together").
    - Legal Challenges → 2023: India issued notice to Pakistan for treaty modification (first time in 62 years).
    - Third-party Involvement → World Bank arbitration → politicisation risk.
    - Pakistan's Overdependence → 90% of agriculture depends on Indus system → existential issue.
  - 4 India's Interests & Concerns
    - Development Rights: India underutilises allowed share of Eastern rivers (10–15% flows still into Pakistan).
    - Hydropower Potential: 18,000 MW possible on Western rivers; only ~3,500 MW developed.
    - National Security: leverage against Pakistan's cross-border terrorism.
    - Climate Uncertainty: glacier retreat in Himalayas threatens water availability.
  - 5 Recent Developments (2022–24)
    - Kishanganga Project (2018): Neutral Expert upheld India's right to divert water within limits.
    - 2023 Notice: India invoked Article XII → sought renegotiation citing misuse of arbitration clauses.
    - 2023–24 Arbitration: PCA (Permanent Court of Arbitration) proceeding in Hague; India refused participation, citing parallel processes.
  - 🚀 Way Forward
    - Renegotiation for Climate Realities → account for glacier melt, variability.
    - Modern Technology Use → joint monitoring via satellites, IoT sensors.
    - Water Efficiency Projects → both nations must reduce wastage in agriculture.
    - Strengthen PIC → empower with dispute-prevention tools.
    - Regional Cooperation → extend dialogue under SAARC/BIMSTEC frameworks for basin-level water management.

Russia
- Intro — Special and previleged strategic partnership
- Conclusion
  - "Our Partnership is a factor of stability in global order" - Valadimir Putin
  - "Russia is a enduring friend and a trusted partner" - Narender Modi
- Dimension
  - Economic
    - Trade
      - $50Bn — driven by oil, coal, fertilisers
      - discounted oil share of russia — 40%
      - long term potash supply deals
      - agreement to boost bilateral trade to 100 Bn by 2030
      - Push for — interoperability of national payment system, financial messagin system , digital currency; settle trade in domestic currency
    - supply chains / connectivity project — INSTC — first tiral complete (25 days); Chennai Valadivstocok eastern maritime corridor
    - infra — MoU signed to build Urea Plant in Russia
    - energy — shakalin oil filelds share by ONGC Videsh; Kundunkulam Nuclear Plant with Russian Help
  - Social
    - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas — Labour Mobility agreement — to provide indian opportunities in semi skilled jobs in Russia; 30day e-tourist visa on reciprocal basis and grant of group tourist visa to russian nationals
    - Humanitarian aid
    - diaster response
  - envt — climate finance
  - Political
    - security — terror; bilateral cooperation
    - national
    - International — BRICS / SCO; support for UN Reforms
  - Tech
    - defense — S 400; Su 57 joint prod; Brahmos; AK 203 joint prod in Amethi; exercise — INDRA
    - science — Space — Gaganyaan astronaut training in Russia; Medical — Pharma API supply; tech transfer Sputnik V vaccine
- Issues — tightrope walk currently due to deep polarisation between russia and europe; additional 25% tarrif imposed by US

US
- Intro — Comprehensive Global strategic partnership
- conclusion — "The partnership between India and the United States will be one of the defining partnerships of the 21st century." - Barack Obama
- Dimension
  - Economic
    - Trade — $128 Bn , $41Bn surplus
    - supply chains / connectivity project — IMEC
    - infra
    - energy — civil nuclear energy deal (India+us); LNG , crude imports from US
  - Social
    - People — diaspora — 5mn; regfugee; visas
    - Humanitarian aid
    - diaster response
  - envt — climate finance
  - Political
    - security — terror; bilateral cooperation — pacts — LEMOA, COMCASA, BECA; GE-414 coproduction MoU
    - national — call for rule based open indo pacific
    - International — IPEF, G20 , etc.
  - Tech
    - defense — satellite information on northern borders; Malabar exercise
    - science — space — NISAR; Artemis Accord; Axiom-4; medical; emerging tech — iCET
- Issue — Tech — export control on defense tech

Bangladesh
- Intro — Prime Minister Narendra Modi has described the current era of bilateral ties as the "Sonali Adhyay"—the golden phase of India-Bangladesh relations.
- Conclusion — Anchored in trust and mutual benefit, this partnership can drive South Asia's transformation into a zone of peace and prosperity.
- Dimension
  - Economic
    - Trade — 14Bn in 2023-24
    - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — Chittagong port access for north east; Maitree express; akhaura-agartala rail; India-Bangladesh Inland waterway route — connects Tripura to National waterways of india througuh Bangladesh
    - water sharing — Ganga water treaty
    - energy — MoU for electricity transfer 1160MW exports from India to bangla; cross border electricity trade from Nepal via india
  - Social
    - People — visas — Swarna Jayanti schlorship for youth of bangladesh studying india
    - Humanitarian aid — India aided thorugh sending supplies to help 3L Rohingiya to support Bangladesh in ints humanitarian efforts; 1.2 Mn doses of vaccine as a grant under Vaccine Maitri intiative
  - envt — climate finance — joint efforts for sunderbans conservation
  - Political
    - International — BIMSTEC, Mekong Ganga Coope
    - geostrategic significance — Connectivity and security to North-East- As the region is landlocked and has better connectivity through Bangladesh.; Maritime Security — located in Bay of Bengal hence it is sessential for securing sea lines communication and trade routes
    - Act East Policy — Bridge to SE asia and important partner in BBIN and BIMSTEC
  - Tech
    - defense — Exercise SAMPRITI
    - science — space; medical
- Issues
  - Economic
    - Trade — trade imabalance and non tarrif barriers; Hasina era duty free access under SAFTA is facing uncertainity
    - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — Indian investments in bangladesh textile industry face risks under new regime; Power sector delays of imported electricity by Bangladesh; Agartala akahura link delay
    - water sharing — Teesta water dispute on equitable water sharing; Joint River commission inactive since 2010
  - Social — People — Minority Rights
    - Minority Hindus persecutions and Bangladesh anti CAA stance
    - Radicalism can embloden extremist elements in India as well
    - communal tensions in West Bengal has often echoed the developments in Bangladesh
  - envt — climate finance
  - Political
    - security — Border — illegal migration, smuggling, ocassional clash
    - International — China's Influence: Bangladesh's growing engagement with China in infrastructure and defense raises strategic concerns for India.; Beijing may exploit the crisis offering economic incentives to the new regime as seen in Srilanka and madives
- way forward
  - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
  - strengthen security to counter spillover effects

Nepal
- Intro — India and Nepal have a unique friendship and cooperation relationship characterized by open borders and deep-rooted people-to-people contacts(Roti-Beti bonds) of kinship and culture.
- conclusion — Respect for sovereignty, economic interdependence, and dialogue can rebuild trust in the partnership.
- Body
  - Current ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — India is Nepal's largest trade partner
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — sea access; Integrated checkpost at Birgunj
      - infra — Indian firms represent 40% FDI of Nepal
      - water sharing — 2008 bilateral mechanism for water cooperation and hydropoweplant development
    - Social
      - People — diaspora — Roti-beti links; visas — open border of 1800km under 1950 treaty of peace and friendship
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
      - Share Buddhist Heritage
      - sister city agreements partnerships focused on shared cultural, religious, and historical ties — Janakpur and Ayodhya
      - Heritage restoration project — Patan Durbar
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - International — BIMSTC, SAARC
      - Neighbourhood First Policy
    - Tech
      - defense — Surya Kiran military exercise; Gorkha regiment in Indian army; Joint Border Managment Committee for continious high level talks
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Social
      - People — visas — open border of 1800km under 1950 treaty of peace and friendship
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — Border — Territorial dsipute near lipulekh and kalapani
      - national
        - Domestic Politics — sensationalist reporting about Nepal in Indian Media; irresponsible statements by Nepali PM KP Oli inluding allegations of India plotting to depose him; rise of territorial nationalism
        - Trust deficit since 2015 unofficial Indian blockade that ravaged Nepali economy
      - International — China factor
        - ties elevated to Strategic Parternship b/w Nepal and China
        - joint exercise in 2017-18
        - financial assistance to Nepali army
        - Nepal joined BRI in 2017
        - security threay — Chinese infra near India Nepal Border — Pokhara airport
        - increased chinese investment may threaten Indias role and energy and trade partner
  - way ahead
    - Big brother image: India has to be mindful of its "big brother" image in a country where the domestic political power play produces a new surprise every few months
    - A transit agreement: To help Nepal trade via India's inland waterways, and other connectivity agreements were also signed during the visit
    - Revision of Friendship Treaty: Kathmandu seeks to regulate traffic along the border as part of an overall revision of the 1950 IndiaNepal Friendship Treaty.
    - Closing loophole in Border — Nepali border being frequently used to infiltrate india

Afghanistan
- Intro
  - Afghanistan has been the center of 'Great Games' and 'Graveyard of Empires'.
  - "Our friendship is as timeless as the mountains and as deep as the valleys of Afghanistan." – Narendra Modi
  - "In the heart of every Afghan, there is a special place for India." – Ashraf Ghani
- conclusion — Respect for sovereignty, economic interdependence, and dialogue can rebuild trust in the partnership.
- Body
  - Significance
    - Afghanistan is the center of radical ideology, drug trafficking and smuggling. Thus peaceful Afghanistan is necessary for regional security
    - important crossroad for commerce and trade as well as gateway to landlocked central asia
    - enormous undeveloped hydrocarbons resources such as oil and gas.
  - Current ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — dry furits and carpets to india; Chahbar port acces; PTA in 2003 , duty cuts for afghan dry fruits
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — zarang-delaram highway; salma friedndship dam 40 MW hydroelectric project; afghan parliament building; TAPI Pipeline; India Afghan air frieght corridor for business
      - infra — $3Bn Aid sicne 2001; 550+ projects in all 34 provinces
    - Social
      - People — visas — Reopening of Indian Embassy in Kabul; cricket as vital connection for people to people ties
      - Humanitarian aid
        - schools and hospitals
        - 70,000 Tonne wheat and SL vaccines during covid 19
        - School Feeding Program: 2 million children receive high-protein biscuits through the World Food Programme.
        - Free Healthcare: 30,000 Afghans receive medical aid monthly through 5 Indian missions.
        - Military Aid: Provided military vehicles, ambulances, and medical supplies
        - 100 cr aid as grants declared for FY 2025-26
      - diaster response
      - ITEC trainign Programme — 500 afghan public servant recieve annual training
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national — 1000+ ITEC (India technical economic cooperation) scholarships
      - International — India promoted afghan inclusion in SAARC in 2005
      - geostrategic significance — connecting east, west, central, north east asia
      - Act West Policy
  - India's shift
    - anti pakistan sentiment (air strike, refugee expulsion) gave india the space to increase its strategic foothold
    - countering china in its investments to maintain india's regional influence
    - safeguarding existing investments
    - minimise internal security threats due to presence to existing terror groups in afghanistan via cooperation
    - safeguard existing investments
  - Issues
    - Economic — Trade — reduced trade post 2021 — 40%
    - Social — Human rights — the degradation of women's and minority rights, the dismantling of a democratic system, and the implementation of the Taliban's harsh brand of justice
    - Political
      - security
        - terror — security vaccum and militancy attacks creating instability; Presence of terror group such as al-queada , ISKP and opium linked terror funding which remains a serious threat
        - bilateral cooperation — lack of formal recognition of taliban
        - Border
      - national — Non Democratic regime
      - International — Chinese footprint — $550Mn investment in Mining; One Belt One Road Initiative; New Great game: Between Pakistan, China, and Russia on one side and the US, India, and Afghanistan on the other
  - way ahead
    - engaging with Taliban — to ask rebels security guarntee in exchange of continuous aid
    - collaboration with regional actors — China, russia, Iran to promote regional peace and stability

Myanmar
- Intro — India-Myanmar relations hold strategic and cultural significance, as Myanmar is the only ASEAN country sharing a land border with India, making it a crucial gateway to Southeast Asia
- Valued Addition — five Bs– — Buddhism, Business, Bollywood, Bharatnatyam, and Burma teak—underscore the depth of this multifaceted partnership
- Conclusion
- Signifcance
  - Strategic Location: Shares a 1,643 km border and maritime boundary in the Bay of Bengal; acts as India's land bridge to Southeast Asia
  - China Containment: India's development of Sittwe Port under SAGAR Vision counters China's Kyaukpyu Port and growing influence in Myanmar.
  - Shared buddisht heritage and civilisational connections
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — $1.74 Bn
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — MIST Cable Project — MIST Cable Project is 8,100 km submarine cable linking Singapore, Malaysia, Myanmar, and India to enhance secure and reliable communication in Asia.
      - infra — $1.75 billion in grantbased aid. Key projects: Kaladan Multimodal Transit, Trilateral Highway.; Sittwe Port in Myanmar; Motor vehicle agreement under negotiation
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid — aid during diaster of cyclone Mora (2017); Operation Braham by India as first responder when 7.7 magnitdue eqarthquake hit myanmar
      - diaster response
      - Ananda Temple restoration support by India
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror — Operation Sunrise: Joint action against NE insurgents along the border; bilateral cooperation; Border — Tamu-Moreh and Rih-Zowkhawthar entry/ exit points operational since 2018.
      - national
      - International — collaboration under BIMSTEC ,India's SAGAR vision
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
    - Tech
      - defense — exercise — IMBAX (Army), IMCOR (Navy)
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — Limited trade engagement and India's withdrawl from RCEP
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee — Rohingiya crisis; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security
        - terror — Insurgency in NR use Myanmar's territory for shelter , operations, espicially near Myanmar china border
        - bilateral cooperation
        - Border — Porous Border; illegal arms, drugs, human trafficking; FMR misuse by insurgent groups
      - national — Military coup in 2021
      - International
        - China factor — Chinese Influence: China's strategic investments, soft power diplomacy, and inclusion of Myanmar in the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) undermine India's influence in the region. — oil and gas pipeline built by china running from Kyaukphyu in rakhine state to Yunnan in china; deap sea port at Kyaphkyu; military supplier (largest of myanmar)
        - authoritarin governance weakns ASEAN's democratci structure thus eroding its cohesiveness and ability to confront China
  - way forward
    - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts; Sensitive Handling of Rohingya Issue: India must balance its ties with Bangladesh and Myanmar while addressing humanitarian and security concerns
    - strengthen border security to counter spillover effects
    - Leveraging shared Buddhist heritage can enhance goodwill and boost tourism and people-to-people ties.
    - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
    - Leverage Multilateral and Regional Platforms: India should collaborate through ASEAN, BIMSTEC, and Quad to promote democratic values, stability, and rule-based order in Myanmar, reducing China's unilateral dominance
    - Accelerate Connectivity Projects: Fast-tracking initiatives like the Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project and India–Myanmar–Thailand (IMT) Highway can reinforce India's role as a reliable partner and secure access to Southeast Asia.

Sri lanka
- Intro
  - As former Sri Lankan PM Mahinda Rajapaksa aptly said, "India is a relative of Sri Lanka while all other countries are friends."
  - India–Sri Lanka relations are shaped by civilizational links, ethnic dimensions, maritime security concerns, and growing Indian Ocean geopolitics.
- Conclusion — A stable Sri Lanka is indispensable for a secure Indian Ocean region.
- Body
  - Significance — Geostrategic Significance: Sri Lanka lies on vital Indian Ocean trade routes, handling 90% of India's maritime trade, making it key to India's Indo-Pacific strategy amid China's growing influence.
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - energy — Adani thermal powerplan to boost electricity generation
      - India's role Recent crisis
        - Currency Swap and Debt Restructuring: India supported Sri Lanka's IMF bailout by extending a $400 million currency swap and endorsing the $2.9 billion IMF relief package, aiding debt restructuring.
        - $4 billion in emergency and LoC assistance during Sri Lanka's 2022 economic crisis.
        - $1Bn in credit Line for essentials
        - India dispatched large-scale food grains, medicines, and essential supplies to mitigate shortages and humanitarian distress.
        - Global Advocacy: India actively lobbied at the IMF, G20, and World Bank, facilitating faster international financial assistance for Sri Lanka.
    - Social
      - People — diaspora — Tamils form people to people connect
      - Humanitarian aid — High Impact Community Development Projects — primarily refer to the grant-based initiatives where India supports small, people-centric projects in Sri Lanka focusing on education (smart classrooms), health (facilities, ambulance service), livelihood (model villages, crèches), and infrastructure (stadiums, cultural centers)
      - diaster response
      - SharedBuddhistheritage, scholarships,
      - ITEC training,
      - and institutions like the Swami Vivekananda Cultural Centre promote people-to-people ties.
    - Political
      - national — India's 'Neighbourhood First' aligns with Sri Lanka's 'India First' policy, balancing China's presence
      - International — CSC , BIMSTEC,; Colmbo security conclave — The Colombo Security Conclave (CSC) is a regional grouping of India, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Maldives, and Mauritius (Seychelles as observer),; focused on maritime security, counter-terrorism, cyber security, trafficking, and disaster relief.
    - Tech
      - defense — Exercise — Mitra Shakti and SLINEX
      - science — space; medical
    - Recent PM Modi visit
      - Agreement on India-Sri Lanka electricity grid; Tripartite MoU (India-SL-UAE) to develop Trincomalee as an energy hub.
      - India converted over USD 100 million in loans into grants, lowered interest on others;
      - launched key projects like solar and railway upgrades
      - Relics of Lord Buddha from Gujarat to be sent to Sri Lanka for Vesak Day celebrations in May 2025
      - India introduced Unified Payment Interface (UPI) in Sri Lanka and authorized the Indian Rupee as a designated currency in 2023.
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — India enjoys a significant trade surplus—exports worth $4.16 billion versus Sri Lanka's $767 million (2018);
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
    - Social — People — Minority Rights — Tamil Issue: Discrimination against Tamils in citizenship, education, and employment continues; dilution of the 13th Amendment and poor implementation of the Indo–Sri Lanka Accord exacerbate ethnic grievances.
    - Political
      - national — Fishermen Issue (Katchatheevu Island): Indian fishermen face arrests for allegedly entering Sri Lankan waters; although traditional fishing rights remain unaccepted despite Joint Working Groups and MoUs.
      - International — China's 99-year lease of Hambantota Port and submarine visits raise strategic concerns for India;; India's stalled involvement in Mattala Airport near the China-run port adds to tensions.
  - way forward
    - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
    - strengthen border security to counter spillover effects
    - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
    - Accelerate Connectivity Projects: Fast-tracking initiatives

Bhutan
- Intro — India–Bhutan relations stand out as a rare example of trust-based diplomacy, characterized by strategic convergence, development cooperation, and mutual respect.
- Conclusion — Respecting Bhutan's autonomy while enhancing economic ties ensures enduring trust.
- Body
  - Significance — Bhutan acts as a buffer between India and China.
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — India is Bhutan's top trade partner; trade rose from USD 484 million (2014–15) to USD 1615 million (2022– 23).
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — Opening of Darranga Integrated Check Post to boost trade and tourism in eastern Bhutan
      - infra — India funds Bhutan's Five-Year Plans (₹4,500 crore for the current plan); Hydropower projects like Mangdechhu enhance energy ties; duty-free transit boosts trade; Project Dantak is a Border Roads Organisation (BRO) project established in 1961 to build crucial infrastructure in Bhutan — Built around 1650 km of roads and 115 km of tracks.
      - water sharing — River data sharing aids flood forecasting and regional water security
      - energy
    - Political
      - security — terror — Joint efforts have tackled insurgent groups like ULFA and NDFB
      - national — Revision of Friendship Treaty (2007)
        - It adopted an element of equality doing away from India's big brother approach.
        - Independent Foreign Policy: Articles 2 and 4 of the revised treaty enabled Bhutan to conduct its foreign policy more independently at the same time keeping India's security interests in mind.
        - Procurement of weapons: Article 4 would allow Bhutan to import military equipment from other countries without India's consent.
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — External debt: India is a major trading partner of Bhutan and has a positive balance of payments, which has caused issues for Bhutan.; The ratio of its GDP to its external debt has risen to almost 100%.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — Delays in hydropower projects: Both nations have decided to work together to enhance Bhutan's hydropower potential by 10,000 MW. India is not completing projects in the anticipated amount of time.
    - Political — International
      - Bhutan did not join the BBIN Motor Vehicle Agreement considering its adverse impact on the environment and climate
      - China Factor — China is in the process to create diplomatic ties with Bhutan which Bhutan has not yet accepted.; China-Bhutan Border Delimitation Meet: China and Bhutan discussed the 3-Step Roadmap (signed in 2021) for border resolution
  - way forward
    - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
    - Diversify Bhutan's exports to reduce external debt and trade imbalace
    - Currency swap support under SAARC framework
    - Fulfill commitment to 10000MW hydropower
    - Continue joint work on satllites (like INS-2B)
    - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
    - Accelerate Connectivity Projects: Fast-tracking initiatives

Maldives
- Intro
  - As a key maritime neighbour, Maldives is central to India's Neighbourhood First Policy and SAGAR vision. However, evolving domestic politics and intensifying great-power competition have tested bilateral trust and strategic alignment.
  - Recent "India Out" narratives and leadership changes in Maldives have underscored the fragility of strategic trust, despite India's role as the first responder in crises and a major development partner.
- Conclusion — Guided by Neighbourhood First and SAGAR, India must recalibrate engagement through development diplomacy, maritime security cooperation, and people-centric projects, ensuring Maldives remains a partner in a free, open, and stable Indian Ocean.
- Significance
  - Maldives is situated near vital sea lanes in the Indian Ocean connecting the Middle East, Africa, South Asia, and Southeast Asia, through which over 80% of India's trade and major global energy shipments pass.
  - Control Over Sea Lines of Communication (SLOCs): Its proximity to key SLOCs—carrying crude oil and LNG from the Persian Gulf to East Asia—makes Maldives critical for monitoring and securing these maritime routes against threats like piracy and terrorism.
  - geostrategic buffer to counter China's growing footprint in the Indian Ocean, particularly its "String of Pearls" strategy aimed to establish ports and bases around India.
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — India became Maldives' 2nd largest trade partner in 2022 and the largest in 2023. Bilateral trade reached nearly $1 billion in 2023-24.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — India Gandhi Memorial Hospital, Maldives; Institute of Technical Education, and; Greater Male Connectivity Project (GMCP) worth $500 million
      - $ 100 Mn financial assistance in 2022
      - currency swap in Dec 2022
      - Talks on FTA, local currency trade, RuPay launch, and Currency Swap Agreement under SAARC framework.
    - capacity building — India provides 70% of defense training for the Maldivian National Defence Force (MNDF).
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid — India sent a 14-member medical team and essential supplies under Operation Sanjeevani in 2020 to aid the Maldives' pandemic response.
      - diaster response — India provided aid after the 2004 tsunami; training for the MNDF Fire and Rescue Service.; 2014 Male water crisis
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
    - Tech
      - defense
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — Subtopic 1
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror — Over 200 Maldivian youths have joined ISIS, with rising radicalization driven by political instability and socio-economic uncertainty; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national — Political instability in the Maldives raises concerns for India's security and regional stability, especially with the "India Out" campaign launched by the Yameen camp,; Maldives opts not to renew hydrographic survey agreement with India, planning to conduct surveys independently.
      - International — The Maldives is part of China's "string of pearls" strategy to contain India; China's debttrap diplomacy allows access to strategic assets, such as the $200 million China-Maldives Friendship Bridge
  - way forward
    - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
    - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
    - Ensure transparency in military engagements to reassure the Maldivian government and public, such as withdrawing excess military personnel while maintaining security cooperation.
    - Offer sustainable alternatives to Chinese investments, like India's funding of Hanimaadhoo International Airport.

USA
- Intro — From Cold War estrangement to strategic convergence, India–USA ties have matured across defence, trade, technology, and diaspora linkages, reflecting India's rising global profile and America's recalibrated Asia strategy.
- Conclusion
- Significance
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — Subtopic 1
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy — Energy ties have been upgraded to a Strategic Energy Partnership (SEP).; Launch of the US–India Climate and Clean Energy Agenda 2030.; Civil nuclear cooperation strengthened through GCNEP and implementation of the 123 Civil Nuclear Agreement, including advanced and modular reactor collaboration.; The US supports India's membership in the International Energy Agency (IEA).
      - The US is India's largest trading partner, with bilateral trade reaching $129 billion (2024).
      - India enjoys a trade surplus of $45.7 billion, though trade imbalances remain a concern for Washington.
      - Both countries have launched 'Mission 500', targeting $500 billion trade by 2030, with a Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA) expected by 2025.
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid — The US diverted vaccine raw materials, filters, oxygen cylinders, and medical supplies to India during COVID-19, reflecting crisis-time strategic trust.
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror — Extradition of Tahawwur Rana, strengthening counter-terror cooperation.; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national — The US views India as a net security provider in the Indian Ocean Region and a strategic counterbalance to China.
      - International — Platforms include QUAD, 2+2 Ministerial Dialogue, and I2U2 (India–Israel–UAE–USA).; The US supports India's permanent UNSC membership, early NSG entry; Joint participation in ISA, Global Biofuels Alliance, IPEF, Artemis Accords, and RETAP.
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
    - Tech
      - defense — The US is India's 4th largest arms supplier.; Foundational defence agreements include GSOMIA (2002), LEMOA (2016), COMCASA (2018), and BECA (2020).; Landmark initiatives include GE–HAL co-production of GE-414 jet engines for Tejas Mk-2, armed drone collaboration, and the INDUS-X defence innovation platform.; India will procure additional P-8I maritime surveillance aircraft, enhancing Indo-Pacific maritime security.
      - science
        - space — Artemis Accord; collaboration in Gaganyaan mission
        - expansion of INDUS — collaboration in AI, semiconductor, space exploration
        - Launch of iCET (2023) to deepen cooperation in AI, semiconductors, defence tech, and space.
        - TRUST initiative to accelerate strategic technologies.
        - Micron investment in Gujarat for semiconductor assembly.
        - NASA–ISRO cooperation, including astronaut training and the NISAR mission.
        - India joined the US-led Minerals Security Partnership (MSP) for access to critical minerals
  - Other
    - AUKUS — Technological capabilities: AUKUS will focus on developing and sharing advanced technologies in areas such as artificial intelligence, cyber, and underwater warfare; Maritime security: AUKUS will also strengthen maritime security in the Indo-Pacific by sharing intelligence, coordinating patrols, and conducting joint military exercises
    - impact — This could lead to a regional arms race and further exacerbate tensions in the region
  - Issues
    - Economic — Trade — Subtopic 1; supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping); infra; water sharing; energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political — security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border; national; International
    - Trade Frictions: US trade deficit with India (~$36 billion, 2024), reciprocal tariffs, GSP withdrawal, and IPR concerns.
    - Strategic Autonomy: India's neutral stance on the Russia–Ukraine war and cautious QUAD positioning.
    - Visa & Immigration Issues: Restrictions on H-1B visas and deportation of undocumented Indian migrants.
    - Human Rights Concerns: Criticism by US bodies like USCIRF, viewed by India as interference.
    - Sanctions Risk: US concerns over India's S-400 purchase under CAATSA.
- way forward
  - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
  - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
  - Conclude BTA to resolve trade, tariff, and IPR issues.
  - Advance defence cooperation through the 2025–2035 defence framework and Reciprocal Defence Procurement Agreement.
  - Ease H-1B visa norms to enhance talent mobility.
  - Secure long-term CAATSA waiver leveraging diaspora influence.
  - Deepen emerging tech cooperation under iCET and TRUST, especially in AI, cybersecurity, and data governance.
  - Mutual respect for domestic diversity to sustain strategic trust.

Russia
- Intro
  - India and Russia share a longstanding, time-tested partnership rooted in deep mutual trust, shared strategic interests, and a common commitment to multilateralism and global peace.
  - At the 2018 Sochi Summit, it was elevated to the status of a "Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership," reflecting its exceptional depth and importance in India's foreign policy.
- Conclusion
- Significance
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — Bilateral trade reached $66 billion (2023–24), largely driven by energy imports.; India extended a $1 billion credit line for Russia's Far East development.; Target set to reach $100 billion trade by 2030.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — Projects like INSTC and Chennai–Vladivostok Corridor improve Eurasian access.
      - water sharing
      - energy — Indian stakes in Sakhalin oil and gas projects.; Collaboration in Arctic hydrocarbon exploration.; Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant stands as a flagship example of civilian nuclear cooperation.; Discounted Russian crude oil helps control inflation.
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national — Launch of India–Russia 2+2 Ministerial Dialogue
      - International — Shared vision of a multipolar world order.; Cooperation in BRICS, SCO, and other multilateral platforms.; Russia's consistent support for India's permanent UNSC membership and the Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism (CCIT).
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
    - Tech
      - defense — Russia remains India's largest arms supplier (≈45% share, 2017–22).; Licensed production of T-90 tanks, Su-30 MKI, AK-203 rifles, and BrahMos missiles.; Procurement of S-400 missile defence system.; Regular INDRA tri-service military exercises enhance interoperability.
      - science
        - space — Russia assisted in launching Aryabhata, India's first satellite.; Training of Indian astronauts for Gaganyaan mission.; Collaboration in cryogenic technology, GLONASS, and satellite applications.
        - medical — tech tranfer in sputnik V vaccine
    - Modi's visit to Russia — PM Modi's Visit to Russia – July 2024 (22nd Annual Summit):; Trade Target: $100 billion by 2030.; Currency Use: Promote bilateral trade in national currencies.; Consular Expansion: New Indian consulates to open in Kazan and Yekaterinburg to support the Indian community and boost ties
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — Subtopic 1
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — Trade & Connectivity Issues: Delays in INSTC, regulatory barriers, and high trade imbalance.
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national — Declining Defence Dependence: Russia's share in India's arms imports has fallen from ~70% (2010–14) to ~45%, as India diversifies suppliers.; India needs to reduce its defence supplies from Russia as part of defence modernization, and diversification and to avoid USA sanctions under CAATSA — CAATSA — CAATSA Act, also known as Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act, was enacted by the USA in 2017 to impose sanctions on three nations, i.e., Russia, Iran, and North Korea
      - International — Transactional Tilt: Post-Cold War ties remain defence-centric, with limited progress in trade, technology, and innovation.; US–Russia Tensions: India must balance ties with Russia without jeopardising relations with the US.; Indo-Pacific Divergence: Russia's Eurasian focus contrasts with India's Indo-Pacific priorities.
- way forward
  - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
  - strengthen border security to counter spillover effects
  - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
  - Accelerate Connectivity Projects: Fast-tracking initiatives

China
- Intro — India–China relations are marked by a complex mix of cooperation and competition. While China is India's largest neighbour and a key trade partner, it also poses strategic challenges to India's regional and global ambitions.
- Conclusion — As PM Modi observed, the relationship must move from "INCH" to "MILES" – a Millennium of Exceptional Synergy.
- Significance
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — In FY 2023–24, bilateral trade reached $127.7 billion
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing — India and China share several transboundary rivers, the most significant being the Brahmaputra (Yarlung Tsangpo) and the Sutlej (Langqen Zangbo).; There is no comprehensive water-sharing treaty between India and China.; China provides hydrological data on the Brahmaputra and Sutlej during monsoon months under bilateral MoUs, renewed annually.; Cooperation on water issues remains limited, conditional, and sensitive, often influenced by broader geopolitical relations.
      - energy
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
      - India and China share deep civilizational links and have promoted cultural exchanges, including institutions such as the Yoga College in China.
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — high-level engagement at forums like BRICS and the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO), reflecting shared interest; Both are major stakeholders in multilateral financial institutions such as the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) and the New Development Bank (NDB).; cooperate within SCO's Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) to address threats from extremist groups.
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
    - Tech
      - defense — 1996 Agreement on Military Confidence-Building Measures along the LAC.; 2013 Border Defence Cooperation Agreement (BDCA).
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — India's trade deficit with China reached $99.5 billion (April 2025).; India depends on China for over 50% of pharmaceutical Key Starting Materials (KSMs).
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing — Data-sharing limitations: China has occasionally withheld or delayed hydrological data, adversely affecting flood forecasting in India's northeast.; Dam and diversion projects: Construction of dams such as the Zangmu Dam and proposed mega-dams raise concerns over downstream water security.; Environmental risks: Large upstream projects threaten ecosystems, sediment flow, and livelihoods in India's northeastern states.
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security
        - terror
        - bilateral cooperation
        - Border
          - China's "Five Finger Policy" and troop deployments of nearly 50,000–60,000 soldiers in eastern Ladakh contribute to tensions.
          - China's "Five Finger Policy" and troop deployments of nearly 50,000–60,000 soldiers in eastern Ladakh contribute to tensions.
          - Salami slicing — China employs incremental territorial encroachments, such as constructing 628 border villages in Tibet, to assert claims.
          - BRI — India opposes the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) due to the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) passing through Pakistan-occupied Jammu & Kashmir; Debt-trap diplomacy: Countries risk losing strategic assets, exemplified by Sri Lanka's Hambantota Port.; Infrastructure and environmental risks: Large projects raise corruption and sustainability concerns; coal-based projects worsen emissions.; Macro-economic risks: High-cost projects strain national debt, e.g., the $6 billion Laos railway.
          - Strategic encirclement — China's "String of Pearls" strategy and projects like Hambantota Port (Sri Lanka) challenge India's regional influence.
          - dual front strategic threat
      - national
      - International
        - Chinese investments have altered regional alignments in countries like Maldives, undermining India's Neighbourhood First Policy.
        - Pakistan: Deep strategic ties via CPEC and Gwadar Port, providing China access to the Arabian Sea.
        - Bangladesh: Largest trade partner and defence supplier; support for energy, nuclear, and satellite projects. ex- Chittagong port
        - Sri Lanka: Control over Hambantota Port and post-war diplomatic backing.
        - Nepal: BRI-backed infrastructure reduces dependence on India; projects include Pokhara Airport and cross-border rail links.
        - Maldives: High debt exposure and long-term leases of islands and infrastructure raise sovereignty concerns. ex- Male Airport , sinamale bridge
        - South China sea Dispute
          - Importance — Trade: Nearly 55% of India's Indo-Pacific trade passes through the South China Sea.; Half of world's shipping vessel operate in the region; Energy Security: India has oil and gas exploration interests in the region through ONGC Videsh.; Strategic Outreach: Stability in the SCS is essential for India's Act East Policy and Indo-Pacific engagement.; Rules-Based Order: India supports freedom of navigation and overflight under UNCLOS.
          - Issue of Chinese expansionism — Threat to Freedom of Navigation: China's militarization of artificial islands threatens global shipping routes vital for India's trade.; Violation of International Law: China's rejection of the 2016 Permanent Court of Arbitration ruling undermines UNCLOS and the rules-based maritime order.; Strategic Encirclement: Chinese presence in Gwadar, Hambantota, and potential access points in the SCS reflects a broader String of Pearls strategy.; Regional Destabilization: Aggressive posture against ASEAN states like the Philippines and Vietnam raises conflict risks in India's extended neighbourhood.
          - way ahead — Diplomacy and Multilateral Engagement: Encourage peaceful, inclusive, and multilateral negotiations among claimant states.; Code of Conduct (COC): Support early finalization of a robust and legally binding ASEAN–China Code of Conduct.; Maritime Cooperation: Promote joint initiatives in marine research, environmental protection, and fisheries management.
  - Recent Devlopment
    - India and China agreed to disengage and resume patrolling in Depsang Plains and Demchok, restoring the pre-May 2020 status quo.
    - disegagement in — Galwan Valley; Hot Springs; Gogra; Pangong Tso
    - China protested PM Modi's visit to Arunachal Pradesh for the inauguration of the Sela Tunnel, calling it "South Tibet".
    - Recent Agression reasons — Reasons for Recent Chinese Aggression; India's border infrastructure development, including the Darbuk–Shyok–DBO road.; Reorganisation of Jammu & Kashmir and creation of Ladakh as a UT.; India's objections to CPEC in Gilgit–Baltistan.; India's growing proximity to the US and QUAD, perceived as anti-China.
  - way forward
    - Water sharing — Finalize a comprehensive water cooperation agreement covering data sharing, dam construction norms, and minimum ecological flow.; Depoliticize water issues, insulating them from broader strategic tensions.; Enhance technical dialogue through joint expert mechanisms on hydrology, climate change, and disaster management.
    - geopolitical
      - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts; high level engagements — WMCC talks
      - Strengthen border infrastructure and military preparedness along the LAC.
      - Enhance maritime capacity via the Andaman & Nicobar Command.
      - Use diplomatic pressure points, including China's sensitivity to the One-China Policy.
      - Expand engagement in the Indian Ocean Region and South China Sea.
      - Build power-balancing alliances and deeper cooperation with like-minded partners, especially the United States. (Quad)

EU
- Intro — India EU partnership is underpinned by shared commitments to pluralism, democracy, rule of law, and a market-based economy, making it a natural strategic convergence in a multipolar world.
- Conclusion
- Body
  - Significance — Geostrategic Cooperation
    - Both India and the EU view China as a strategic competitor, particularly in connectivity, trade, and global governance.
    - The EU's Global Gateway (Golden Gateway) Initiative seeks to provide a transparent and sustainable alternative to China's Belt and Road Initiative.
    - The EU's Indo-Pacific Strategy places India at its core, recognizing India's role as a net security provider in the Indian Ocean Region. — Maritime Security: India safeguards Indian Ocean sea lanes carrying nearly 35% of EU's trade.
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — Trade: India–EU bilateral trade in goods reached USD 137.41 billion in 2023–24; Trade and Technology Council (TTC): Launched to strengthen cooperation on trade, trusted technology, digital governance, and supply chain resilience.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — April 2000 and September 2024, cumulative EU FDI in India stood at USD 117.4 billion, accounting for 16.6% of India's total FDI inflows.
    - Political — security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border; Defence Manufacturing: European firms support Make in India, e.g., Airbus C-295 aircraft project.
    - Tech — India–UK Global Innovation Partnership (GIP): Co-financing of up to USD 100 million over 14 years.; India–EU Trade and Technology Council (2022): Focus on digital governance, AI, semiconductors, and innovation.; Horizon 2020: Joint research initiatives in climate change, polar research, and advanced sciences.
  - Recent Developments — Broad-Based Trade and Investment Agreement (BTIA)
    - Proposed India–EU Free Trade Agreement; negotiations began in 2007.
    - Issues — EU demands tariff reduction on dairy, wines, spirits, and automobiles.; India demands removal of EU's non-tariff barriers (SPS and TBT).; EU's insistence on stronger IPR and data exclusivity rejected by India.; EU has not granted data-secure country status to India.
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — Trade Disputes: EU demands tariff reduction in automobiles and pharmaceuticals.; Intellectual Property: EU criticism of India's IPR regime, including compulsory licensing.; CBAM: EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism may impose up to 25% tax on Indian exports, affecting 0.05% of GDP.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
    - Social — People — Minority Rights — Human Rights Concerns: EU concerns over CAA 2019, minority rights, and governance issues.
    - Political
      - national — Political Shifts in Europe: Rise of anti-migration and ultra-nationalist sentiment, exemplified by Brexit.
      - International — China Dependency: India's share in EU imports has stagnated while China's share has grown since 2010.; Foreign Policy Differences: Divergence on Iran, Balkans, and West Asia.
- way forward
  - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
  - strengthen border security to counter spillover effects
  - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
  - Accelerate Connectivity Projects: Fast-tracking initiatives

Japan
- Intro
  - As India emerges as a key economic and strategic partner, the relationship has deepened into a Special Strategic and Global Partnership, spanning infrastructure, defence, technology, and Indo-Pacific security.
  - India–Japan relations are anchored in strong civilizational links, shared democratic values, and converging strategic interest
- Conclusion — Anchored in shared democratic values and converging Indo-Pacific interests, India–Japan relations are poised to emerge as a cornerstone of regional stability and sustainable global growth.
- Significance — Shared vision for a Free, Open, and Rules-Based Indo-Pacific.; Japan's Free and Open Indo-Pacific (FOIP) vision closely aligns with India's regional strategy.
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA): Covered trade in goods, services, investments, and IPR.; Japan is among India's top five FDI sources, investing in automobiles, electronics, finance, and pharmaceuticals.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — 2021 – Supply Chain Resilience Initiative (SCRI): Launched by India, Japan, and Australia to counter China's dominance in Indo-Pacific supply chains.
      - infra — Blue Dot Network focus on transparent and sustainable infrastructure.; Joint initiatives such as the Asia-Africa Growth Corridor (AAGC); Japan is India's largest Official Developmental Assistance ODA partner, funding metro rail projects, water supply, rural development, and connectivity.; Flagship projects like the Mumbai–Ahmedabad Bullet Train.
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border; Exercise — Dharma Guardian (Army); Malabar (Naval)
      - national — 2+2 Ministerial Dialogue (since 2016) institutionalises strategic and defence coordination.
      - International — Active cooperation in QUAD and SCRI to ensure maritime and economic security.; Coordination in G4 for UN Security Council reforms.; Cooperation in G20 and G7 outreach on climate action, circular economy, and global governance.
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
    - Tech
      - defense
      - science — space — Cooperation in Science & Technology, including ISRO–JAXA Lunar Polar Exploration Mission (LUPEX).; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — Limited Bilateral Trade: Despite CEPA, trade remains modest due to Japan's stringent quality standards and non-tariff barriers.; Low FDI Share: Japanese investment in India is relatively small compared to its global FDI outflows.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — Project Delays: Slow progress in AAGC and Mumbai–Ahmedabad bullet train
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — Strategic Divergences: India is cautious on Taiwan and South China Sea, while Japan aligns more closely with US positions.; Russia-Ukraine Divide: Japan supports Western sanctions; India follows strategic autonomy.
  - way forward
    - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
    - strengthen border security to counter spillover effects
    - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
    - Accelerate Connectivity Projects: Fast-tracking initiatives
    - Track II diplomacy — India–Japan Forum 2024 — Organised by Ananta Centre and MEA, serving as a platform for strategic dialogue.

India South east asia
- Intro — Southeast Asia, located south of China, east of the Indian subcontinent, and northwest of Australia, comprises 11 countries divided into mainland and island regions
- Conclusion — India's engagement with Southeast Asia and Indonesia is central to Act East, ASEAN Centrality, and India's vision of a free, open, and inclusive Indo-Pacific.
- Body
  - Significance — critical hub of global trade, geopolitics, and strategic competition
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — ASEAN is India's 4th largest trading partner, accounting for 11% of India's global trade.; India–ASEAN trade stood at $122.67 billion in 2023–24.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping) — Mekong–India Economic Corridor (MIEC) promotes regional economic integration. — ocus areas include tourism, culture, education, transport, and communication.
      - infra — India–Myanmar–Thailand Trilateral Highway.; Kaladan Multimodal Transit Transport Project enhances access to India's Northeast.
      - water sharing
      - energy — ndia cooperates in renewable energy, oil, and natural gas projects. — Example: Oil exploration in Vietnam's Nam Con Son Basin.
    - Social
      - People — diaspora — Buddhism from India in the 5th century BCE forms a strong cultural linkage.; regfugee; visas; temple restoration projects such as Angkor Wat and Ta Prohm in Cambodia.
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy — ASEAN is central to India's Act East Policy and Indo-Pacific vision.
      - Defense — Exercise — Garuda Shakti military exercise with Indonesia exemplifies defence collaboration.; Logistics support agreement with Singapore's Changi Naval Base.
    - Tech
      - defense — Defense exports — brahmos to phillphines
      - science — Joint R&D initiatives are supported through the ASEAN–India Science & Technology Development Fund.
  - Recent Event
    - 21st ASEAN–India Summit — 10-Point Plan to enhance connectivity and resilience.; Review of the ASEAN–India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.; Launch of the ASEAN–India Fund for Digital Future.
    - ASEAN Centrality — ASEAN Centrality refers to ASEAN's leading role in shaping Indo-Pacific regional architecture through platforms like EAS(East Asia Summit), ARF(ASEAN Regional Forum), and ADMM+(Asean defense minister meeting).; Significance
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — India's exit from RCEP affected economic trust.; India's trade deficit with ASEAN rose to $44 billion (2023).
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — Delays in key connectivity projects.
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People
      - diaspora — Indian businesses like Tata Group contribute to economic growth. — Tata rrust in rural thailand doing philanthropic work; Cultural influence through epics like Ramayana and Mahabharata.
      - regfugee
      - visas
      - Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national — India indonest marime border demarcation not happened yet
      - International — Expanding Chinese influence via BRI.
      - Defense
  - way forward
    - Implement the 10-Point Plan for connectivity and resilience.
    - Upgrade the ASEAN–India FTA to address trade imbalance.
    - Balance Diplomacy — Support diplomacy while staying neutral in internal conflicts
    - strengthen border security to counter spillover effects
    - Enhancing Security Cooperation: Strengthening joint operations and intelligence sharing is essential for stability and economic collaboration.
    - Accelerate Connectivity Projects: Fast-tracking initiatives

West Asia
- Intro — India–West Asia relations are shaped by geography, history, energy interdependence, diaspora linkages, and strategic interests.
- Conclusion — West Asia remains indispensable to India's energy security, economic growth, and strategic autonomy, requiring calibrated diplomacy and diversified partnerships.
- Significance — Stretching from the eastern Mediterranean to the Arabian Peninsula,
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — India–UAE trade reached $83.7 billion (FY 2023–24) under CEPA.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — INSTC: Multimodal corridor connecting India with West Asia, Central Asia, and Europe.; Ashgabat Agreement: Enhances transit and trade between Central Asia and the Persian Gulf; India joined in 2018.; Projects like Chabahar Port enhance India's access to Central Asia and Afghanistan.; India–Middle East–Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) — Railways, ship-rail links, roads, electricity cables, hydrogen pipelines, and digital connectivity.
      - water sharing
      - energy — Qatar: India's largest LNG supplier, meeting 41% of natural gas imports. — Long-term LNG contracts ensure energy security (e.g., India–Qatar LNG deal extended till 2048).; Around 60% of India's crude oil imports come from Gulf countries; UAE's ADNOC stores crude oil in India's strategic petroleum reserves.; Gulf investments in India's solar and green hydrogen sectors. — example UAE sponsored solar park in gujrat
    - Social
      - People — diaspora — West Asia hosts a large Indian workforce, especially in the Gulf, making India one of the largest sources of migrant labour globally.; UAE home to ~3.4 million Indians.; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid — India has extended humanitarian aid during crises, including assistance to Syria during the civil war and post-earthquake relief under Operation Dost (2023)
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation — Indian Navy patrols under Operation Sankalp to secure sea lanes in the Persian Gulf.; Border
      - national
      - International — Engagement with OIC(Organisation of Islamic Countries), including India's participation as guest of honour (2019).
      - geostrategic significance — West Asia occupies a central place in India's foreign policy due to its role in energy security, trade, connectivity, and regional stability.
      - Defense — Exercise; Oman: Access to Duqm Port strengthens India's maritime presence in the Arabian Sea.
      - 'Look West' Policy (2014 onwards): — Focuses on deepening economic, strategic, and cultural ties while avoiding entanglement in conflicts.
    - Tech
      - defense — Exercise
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights; Sectarian Divides: Managing relations across Shia–Sunni fault lines. — Iran Shia, Saudi Sunni
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — Israel–Palestine and Iran–Saudi tensions require diplomatic balancing.; China's expanding footprint challenges India's influence.; Political Instability: Conflicts in Syria, Yemen, and Iraq threaten Indian interests.
      - Defense
  - way forward
    - Boost Economic Cooperation: Fast-track FTA with GCC and expand investments in infrastructure and technology.
    - Maintain Strategic Balance: Continue de-hyphenated, interest-based diplomacy across regional rivalries.

Iran
- Intro — India–Iran relations are rooted in civilizational continuity and strategic necessity, often described as a partnership "older than history and stronger than geopolitics."
- Conclusion — Guided by strategic autonomy and Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam, India must pursue calibrated engagement with Iran—leveraging Chabahar, INSTC, and multilateral forums like BRICS and SCO—to enhance energy security, connectivity, and regional stability without compromising its global partnerships.
- Body
  - Significance
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
        - Chabahar Port Development — Originates from the 2016 tripartite agreement among India, Iran, and Afghanistan.; India signed a 10-year agreement with Iran to develop and operate the Shahid Beheshti Terminal at Chabahar Port.; offering India direct access to Afghanistan and Central Asia.; Gateway to Central Asia: Provides access to landlocked countries such as Kazakhstan, Turkmenistan, and Afghanistan.; Offers a viable alternative to the Suez Canal for Eurasian trade.
        - Cooperation under the International North–South Transport Corridor (INSTC) reduces transit time and shipping costs for India's trade with Central Asia and Europe.
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social
      - People — diaspora — Shared Religious Heritage: The migration of Zoroastrians from Iran to India led to the establishment of the Parsi community, which has preserved its Iranian heritage while contributing significantly to India's socio-economic and cultural life.; Persian influence is visible in Mughal architecture and the Urdu language, symbolizing centuries of cultural exchange.
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — India supported Iran's entry into BRICS (2023), enhancing cooperation on multilateral platforms.
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
      - Defense — Exercise
    - Tech
      - defense — Exercise
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — Economic volatility, inflation, and political unrest affect long-term bilateral project execution.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — Political and bureaucratic hurdles have delayed projects like the Chabahar–Zahedan railway and INSTC.
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — U.S. sanctions disrupted oil imports and infrastructure investments; India had to halt Iranian oil imports after the U.S. withdrew from the JCPOA.; CAATSA sections; India's deepening ties with the U.S. and Israel complicate relations with Iran, requiring careful diplomatic balancing.; Iran's involvement in Middle Eastern conflicts, including Yemen, complicates India's neutral and pragmatic West Asia policy.
      - Defense
- way forward
  - Ensure Energy Security: Revive long-term gas cooperation beyond sanctions; accelerate regional alternatives like the TAPI gas pipeline.
  - Deepen Infrastructure Cooperation: Invest in oil, petrochemicals, and offshore fields like Farzad-B;
  - support Indian SMEs in the Chabahar Free Trade Zone.

Israel
- Intro
  - From cautious engagement to a bold strategic embrace, India–Israel relations have evolved into a high-trust partnership anchored in defence, technology, and counter-terrorism.
  - As PM Modi noted, the ties are driven by "innovation, security, and shared democratic values," reflecting India's pragmatic West Asia policy and strategic autonomy.
- Conclusion — Guided by India's de-hyphenation policy and national interest–first diplomacy, the partnership must now expand into trade, cyber security, climate tech, and innovation.
- Significance
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — USD 10.1 billion (FY 2022–23); India–Israel Industrial R&D and Innovation Fund (I4F) promotes joint innovation and startups.
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — Structured cooperation through three-year work plans for agri and water cooperation
      - water sharing — MoU on Water Resource Management (2016) focusing on drip irrigation and water efficiency.
      - energy — Indian firms such as ONGC Videsh and Indian Oil awarded exploration licences in Tamar and Leviathan gas fields.
    - Social
      - People — diaspora — Around 85,000 Indian-origin Jews reside in Israel.; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — Quad-like grouping involving India, Israel, UAE, and the US (formed in 2021).; Focus areas: economic development, food security, clean energy, technology, and regional stability.
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
      - Defense — Exercise; Israel is among India's top defence suppliers. — Israeli AWACS, UAVs, missile defence systems, and precision-guided munitions.
    - Tech
      - defense — Exercise
      - science — space; medical; Joint Committee on Science & Technology (1993) institutionalizes collaboration.
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International
        - Iran Factor: Israel views Iran as a security threat, while India values Iran for energy security and Chabahar connectivity.
        - Arab World Sensitivities: Israel's tensions with Arab states require India to balance its West Asia diplomacy carefully.
        - China Factor: China is Israel's largest Asian trading partner, especially in technology and infrastructure sectors.
        - Israel–Palestine Conflict: Periodic escalations complicate India's diplomatic balancing act. — India supports a two-state solution while deepening defence ties with Israel.; De-hyphenation Policy: Independent engagement with Israel and Palestine based on mutual interests.
      - Defense
- way forward — Intensify cooperation against terrorism, radicalisation, and cyber threats by adopting Israel's layered cyber defence model and real-time intelligence exchange.

Central Asia
- Intro — "Geography may divide nations, but history and shared interests unite them."
- Conclusion
  - Located at the geostrategic heart of Eurasia, Central Asia forms a crucial part of India's Extended Neighbourhood. India's engagement with the region dates back to the Indus Valley Civilisation, and today it is driven by energy security, connectivity, counter-terrorism, and multipolar geopolitics—aligned with India's vision of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam and Act West Policy.
  - "Connectivity is the currency of the 21st century."
  - For India, Central Asia is not a peripheral region, but a strategic pivot for energy security, Eurasian connectivity, and regional stability
- Body
  - Significance
    - Kazakhstan → 43% of world's uranium
    - Uzbekistan → Uranium & gold reserves
    - Turkmenistan: — 4th largest gas reserves globally
    - Strategic bridge between West Asia, Eurasia & South Asia
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — India–CAR trade crossed $1 billion (2023) – rising trajectory
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — INSTC (International North–South Transport Corridor) — Multimodal route linking India with Iran, Russia, Central Asia & Europe; Ashgabat Agreement — Objective: Seamless movement of goods between Central Asia & Persian Gulf
      - water sharing
      - energy — TAPI Pipeline (cleaner fossil fuel transition)
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
      - Historical ties
        - Since 3rd century BCE, India maintained strong ties with Central Asia — Large parts of present-day CAR were under the Kushan Empire, facilitating civilisational exchange
        - Scholars & saints like Al-Biruni, Amir Khusro, Sufi saints enriched Indo-Islamic culture
        - Ancient Silk Road connected India with Central Asia
        - Scholars & saints like Al-Biruni, Amir Khusro, Sufi saints enriched Indo-Islamic culture
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror — Cooperation in counter-terrorism & SCO-RATS; bilateral cooperation; Border; Proximity to Golden Crescent (terror & narcotics hub)
      - national
      - International — Shared concern over Afghanistan stability; SCO Membership
      - geostrategic significance — INSTC & Chabahar Port → Gateways bypassing Pakistan
      - Act East Policy
      - Defense — Exercise
    - Tech
      - defense — Exercise — DUSTLIK – Uzbekistan; KHANJAR – Kyrgyzstan; KAZIND – Kazakhstan
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — Low Trade Volume: Below potential (< $5 bn)
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — Delay in INSTC & underutilised Chabahar
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror — Taliban resurgence, extremism, Golden Crescent; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — Chinese Dominance: — OBOR + deep investments marginalise India
      - Defense
- way forward
  - Revisit base access in Tajikistan
  - Coordinate with Russia to balance China
  - 🤝 Pragmatic Taliban Engagement: — Essential for connectivity & market access
  - FTA with Eurasian Economic Union

Australia
- Intro
  - "In a turbulent Indo-Pacific, trusted partnerships matter more than ever."
  - India Australia ties have evolved from transactional engagement to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership (CSP) in 2020. Today, the relationship is anchored in Indo-Pacific stability, economic resilience, clean energy, and people-to-people ties, guided by India's Act East Policy and SAGAR vision.
- Conclusion — By leveraging platforms like the Quad, ECTA, clean energy partnerships, and defence cooperation, both nations are well-positioned to act as pillars of stability and prosperity in a rapidly shifting global order.
- Body
  - Significance
    - Leading global producer of lithium, cobalt, rare earths
    - Supports India's: — EV transition; Renewable energy goals
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — India–Australia ECTA: — Tariff reductions; Market access for goods & services; India imports: Coal, LNG; Australia imports: Textiles, pharma, IT services
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy — Joint Hydrogen Taskforce promotes hydrogen development
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; education — Mutual Recognition of Qualifications Agreement; Australia–India Business Exchange (AIBX): — to boost trade and market connectivity
      - Humanitarian aid
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International
        - Shared concerns over: — China's assertiveness; Rules-based maritime order
        - Quad
        - Australia–India Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative Partnership (AIPOIP) enhances maritime governance and promotes maritime collaboration
        - Supply Chain Resilience Initiative (SCRI) with Japan strengthens diversification
        - G20
        - IORA
        - Indo-Pacific forums
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
      - Defense — Exercise — AUSTRAHIND Army; AUSINDEX; Ministerial-level 2+2 dialogue; Mutual Logistics Support Agreement; Air to Air Refuelling agreement
    - Tech
      - defense — Exercise
      - science — space; medical
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade — Delay in CECA finalisation; Non-tariff barriers: — Sanitary & technical standards
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora — 125% hike in visa fees affecting indian student and educational exchanges; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights — Temple vandalism in Melbourne
    - Political
      - security — terror — Rising Khalistani activities; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International
      - Defense
- way forward — Expedite CECA

Africa
- Intro
  - "India and Africa are not bound merely by interests, but by history, humanity, and hope." – Nelson Mandela
  - India–Africa relations are rooted in shared anti-colonial struggles, South–South solidarity, and a common aspiration for inclusive and sustainable growth.
- Conclusion — By leveraging ITEC, ISA, health diplomacy, and Global South leadership, India can position itself as Africa's most credible long-term partner in a multipolar world.
- Significance — scope for value-adding trade and long-term investments
  - A large working-age population
  - Rapidly growing middle class
  - Expanding services sector
  - Africa rich in diamonds, gold, platinum, and strategic minerals
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic
      - Trade — reached $98 billion in 2023
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra — Pan-African e-Network support training and education — Sharing India's knowledge in education and health to build African capacity; Used satellite, fiber-optic, and wireless networks for connectivity.; Provided tele-education (degrees, diplomas), telemedicine (specialty consultations), e-governance, e-commerce, resource mapping, and meteorological services.; A collaboration between the Indian Government (Ministry of External Affairs) and the African Union, with bodies like TCIL and Apollo Hospitals involved.
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social
      - People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; African patients formed 21.2% of India's medical tourists in 2023 — Driven by affordable healthcare, quality services, and e-visa facilitation; Over 25,000 African students enrolled across Indian universities; Indian universities offer scholarships to African students
      - Humanitarian aid — Indian generics address HIV/AIDS, malaria, and tuberculosis
      - diaster response
    - envt — climate finance
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — International Solar Alliance (ISA) includes several African members; India supported African Union's permanent G20 membership (2023); Asia–Africa Growth Corridor (AAGC) launched with Japan in 2017
      - geostrategic significance
      - Act East Policy
      - Defense — Exercise
    - Tech
      - defense — Exercise
      - science — space; medical
    - capacity building — Technical and Economic Cooperation (ITEC) — 2019: First e-ITEC pilot launched for two African countries — Courses expanded to big data, WTO issues, solar technology
  - Issues
    - Economic
      - Trade
      - supply chains / connectivity project (three modes of transport rail, waterway, coastal shipping)
      - infra
      - water sharing
      - energy
    - Social — People — diaspora; regfugee; visas; Minority Rights
    - Political
      - security — terror; bilateral cooperation; Border
      - national
      - International — Chinese Engagements in Africa — Chinese firms dominate infrastructure and resource extraction projects; Loan-based financing raises debt sustainability concerns; Military bases and peacekeeping after regional security dynamics — somalia , djibotui bases
      - Defense — Regions of Instability — sudan conflict, DRC conflict; it increases peacekeeping security burden
- way forward — India–Africa Forum Summit on regular basis

SAARC
- Intro
  - The South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC) is South Asia's principal regional intergovernmental organisation. Established in December 1985 at Dhaka, its headquarters are in Kathmandu, Nepal.
  - SAARC comprises 8 members – Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan and Sri Lanka.
  - 3% of global land area, 21% of global population, and 4.21% of global GDP, highlighting both its demographic weight and developmental paradox.
- Conclusion — Reviving SAARC through pragmatic cooperation, people-centric engagement, and economic integration is essential for India's Neighbourhood First Policy and long-term regional stability.
- Body
  - Current Ties
    - Economic — Trade
      - SAPTA & SAFTA — Frameworks created to boost intra-regional trade; Intended to reduce tariffs and trade barriers
      - 🏛 SAARC Arbitration Council — Provides legal framework for commercial and trade dispute resolution; Enhances investor confidence and rule-based cooperation
    - Social
      - People — Promote cultural exchanges to strengthen regional harmony and peace; Foster shared identity based on common history and civilisational links; South Asian University — Established in New Delhi to nurture regional leadership; Encourages academic collaboration among SAARC nations
      - Humanitarian aid — Indian Hosts SAARC Disaster Management Centre, Gujarat
    - Political
      - national — RBI's SAARC Currency Swap Framework (2024–27) ensures liquidity support; India led SAARC COVID-19 Emergency Fund (2020)
      - International — Provides middle path between hyper-nationalism and globalisation
      - geostrategic significance — Acts as gateway linking South Asia with Southeast Asia
    - Tech — science — space — GSAT-9, also known as the South Asia Satellite, is an Indian geosynchronous communication satellite launched by ISRO on May 5, 2017, to provide telecommunications, tele-medicine, tele-education, and disaster relief services to South Asian nations (Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Nepal, Maldives, Sri Lanka), offering Ku-band transponders for shared use and fostering regional cooperation.
  - Issues
    - Political
      - national — Domestic political issues spill into regional relations — Eg: CAA–NRC concerns (Bangladesh), Madhesi issue (Nepal); Assymetric Development — India's size creates imbalance within SAARC
      - International — India–Pakistan Tensions — Persistent hostility paralyses institutional functioning; No SAARC summit held since 2014; Border disputes limit cooperation and mutual confidence
    - Structural — ⚖ Consensus-Based Decision Making — Charter mandates unanimity, enabling veto politics; Pakistan blocked Motor Vehicles and Railways Agreements
- way forward

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